and eventually turned up with a friend, and we all had a good time.

And that was still that. She was busy with her studies, I was busy with my cricket and, while we came across one another now and then, the rest of 2007 passed … 2008 passed … 2009 passed … most of 2010 passed.

It was Saturday, 4 December 2010, and the occasion was the wedding of my brother, Wessels, at Chateau Larize, near Bela-Bela. Danielle had been asked to sing at the reception, and she was performing 'This Year's Love', written by David Gray, one of my favourite songs. I sat and listened, in awe, entranced.

And won't you kiss me
On that midnight street
Sweep me off my feet
Singing ain't this life so sweet
This year's love had better last
This year's love had better last

It was an amazing moment and, not long afterwards, our relationship finally started to gather some momentum. Danielle was by now living and working in Cape Town, and I was still charging around the world playing cricket, but we saw each other on a regular basis and started going out. Early in 2012, I reached a clear decision that Danielle was the woman I wanted to marry. This was going to be the match that really mattered.

I wanted to do everything properly and so, on Tuesday, 7 February 2012, just three days before I was due to leave for New Zealand with the Proteas, I arranged to meet her parents, John and Alida, in Pretoria, and ask whether they would give me permission to ask their daughter to marry me. I was unbelievably nervous, but I need not have worried. They not only said yes, but also agreed to help me find the right diamond and have the engagement ring made while I was away on tour.